

on third base and Ed Charles has not been able to turn the double play with assurance.

And of course there is NO Carlton Willey around to win every time he started, as Carlton did for a couple months last year, and not even a Joe Jay.

But the keenest lack has been in relief hurling, where at this time last year Wichita was blessed with two of the best, Don McMahon and Phil Paine.

The Braves boss is in a way embarrassed by having too many players, and he can't locate his regulars, nor his pinch hitters. Last year his team was pretty well set from the start, and except for discarding Toby Atwell, it went through until Milwaukee started its late season raids. Covington and Pizarro helped out in June, Malkmus was borrowed for a time but the rest of the lineup, and the key men, stayed.

This season may see quite a few more changes, shifts and discards. It's too early to dismiss pennant chances but they surely don't look promising.

"You'll get some help," the Denver press tried to smooth things over, after rubbing it in with two close wins, Sunday. Yep, but so will the others, except perhaps Louisville, Charleston and Indianapolis.

So the next two weeks will tell it. Wichita must get going, and right soon. Ben Geraghty admitted on his return from Florida that "these games in April count just as much as the ones in August." Which is right, winning or losing, they stay in the standings.

Of the new men, Al Spangler has impressed the most. Mike Roarke, bothered with a sore left arm, hasn't had a base hit.

And it looked like Wichita was back in Western League ball Sunday when a pitcher was sent in to pinch hit for a regular outfielder, a move which Andy Cohen smothered by inserting a southpaw pitcher, Jack McMahon.

The Denver lefty was nearly mobbed by his jubilant mates when he got the game over on a double play. The Bears acted like high school kids winning their first basketball game.

The Men Do Move

The 1956 scorebook of the Denver-Wichita opener, reveals that only three of the 18 starters, played in the first Denver-Wichita game the past week. Denver's lineups of '56, had Held, Kubek, Martyn, Fridley, Throneberry, Paula, Kline, Neeman and Blyszka, to start the season, and Wichita's was Garcia, Hazle, Hersh, Taylor, Charles, Queen, Thorpe, Koppe and Jay. Next day Hallgren, Leppert and Hartman played for Wichita.

Later on, Taylor, Thorpe, Hallgren and others left and Hanebrink, Bollweg, McHugh and others got in.

Hanebrink by the way is given a big spread in this week's Sporting News, and how the Wichita third sacker of last year has become an outfielder. "While Hanebrink, now 30, tried eagerly to capitalize on his unexpected opportunity, Bob Hazle found himself in the incongruous position of having to prove himself all over again after hitting .403 last season," writes Bob Wolf, Milwaukee scribe.

"As the season began the burden of proof rested on the pitchers. They still hadn't been able to get him (Hazle) out," Wolf quips.